

M. Dalbert Ma

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Office: RB.R3.31

Research interests AI & Organizations; Human–AI Interaction; Organizational Design; Strategy

Education

London Business School

PhD in Strategy & Entrepreneurship 2027

IESE Business School

MSc in Management 2020

Pompeu Fabra University

LLM in Law & Economics 2019

University of York

BA in Philosophy, Politics & Economics 2018

Job Market Paper

The Organizational Tradeoff of AI Coordination:
Evidence from a Container Port

Awards (2026): AOM Litschert Award; AOM STR Best Paper Award;
AOM William H. Newman Dissertation Award (finalist);
SMS Best PhD Paper Prize (finalist).

Selected presentations (2026): Wharton WINDS; MIT Business Implications of GenAI;
Columbia ECDC; Duke Strategy PhD Conference; CCC; SEI Consortium; UCL AI
Plus Management Consortium; Harvard AI Institute OUI; AOM; Oxford ISA; SMS.

Publications

Generative AI and the Architecture of Knowledge Work:
Expertise Bypass, Exchange Governability, and Shifting Bottlenecks
With M.G. Jacobides, A. Das, S. Iyer, and M. Langione
Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal (Forthcoming)

Working Papers

What Are Generative AI's Competitive Implications?
A Longitudinal Documentation of Corporate Director Expectations
With M.G. Jacobides
2nd round reject and resubmit, Strategic Management Journal

The Value of Human-in-the-Loop: Evidence from Self-Driving Logistics
With F. Brahm and S. Sun

Realizing Physical and Digital Synergies in Multi-Business Firms:
A Configurational Approach
With M.G. Jacobides

Work in Progress

Generative AI and the Shifting Locus of Innovation:
Start-ups, Incumbents, and Programming Consolidation
With K. Vakili (IEPC-funded)

Generative AI and Schumpeterian Competition:
Shifting Logics in Technological Regimes
With S. Puntoni and M.G. Jacobides (Wharton AI & Analytics-funded)

Task Interdependence and the Attribution of AI's Value:
Evidence from a Team-Production Experiment
With K. McElheran (shortlisted for Google AI & Economy Research Grant)

AI Agents and Entrepreneurial Performance:
A National Rollout of an AI Operating System
With R. Clarke (implementation partner secured)

Generative AI and Knowledge Hierarchies Inside Firms:
Evidence from Enterprise Telemetry
With R. Clarke and E.Y. Cheng (data partnership secured)

Practitioner Publications

The Business Value of Gamification
With M.G. Jacobides, K. Trantopoulos, and V. Vassalos
California Management Review, 2024.

Assessing the Expected Impact of Generative AI
on the UK Competitive Landscape
With M.G. Jacobides
UK Government Policy Report, 2024.

Generative AI Is Not Just Changing Work. It Is Reallocating It
With M.G. Jacobides, A. Das, and M. Langione
Forbes, 2026.

Symposia

Co-organizer, "Diversification in the Digital Age"
With L. Capron, M.G. Jacobides, G. Lanzolla, C. Markides, and P. Puranam
SMS Annual Conference (October 2024)

Co-organizer, "Opening the Black Box of Diversification"
With C. Baldwin, C.E. Helfat, M.G. Jacobides, C. Magelssen, and J. Santalo
AOM Annual Meeting (August 2024)

Awards

AOM Robert J. Litschert Best Doctoral Student Paper Award, 2026
AOM STR Division Best Paper Award, 2026
AOM William H. Newman Dissertation Award Finalist, 2026
SMS Best PhD Paper Prize Finalist, 2026
LBS Sir James Ball Award 25/26 (Runner-Up), 2025

Grants	Noorjehan Pirani PhD Fellowship Award, £10,000, 2026	
	LBS Research & Materials Development Grant, £10,000, 2026	
	Institute of Entrepreneurship and Private Capital Grant, £9,500, 2024	
Teaching	London Business School	
	Tutor, Developing Strategy for Value Creation (EMBA)	2022–2026
	TA, Profit, Power & Fairness in the Digital Economy (MBA)	2024–2026
	Tutor, Next Generation Digital Strategy (EMBA)	2024–2025
	Tutor, Aramco Executive Finance Strategy Programme (EMBA)	2025
Case Studies	Tanla & Indosat: An AI-Powered Shield Against a National Crisis, LBS 2026	
	Building the Phygital Ecosystem: The Journey of Majid Al Futtaim, LBS 2024	
	Facing the Retail Apocalypse: Majid Al Futtaim’s Transformation, LBS 2024	
	HDFC ERGO: A Product Ecosystem Built on Mindshare, LBS 2024	
	From PingAn’s Inspiration to HDFC ERGO’s Journey, LBS 2024	
	From Products to Experience Ecosystems: Haier’s Internet of Food, LBS 2022	
	Bridgewater Associates: Chasing Alpha, IESE 2022	
	Technical Note: Central Bank Digital Currencies, IESE 2022	
Service	Technical Note: Challenger Banks, IESE 2022	
	<i>Ad-hoc reviewer:</i> Industrial and Corporate Change; Long Range Planning	
	<i>Conference reviewer:</i> AOM; Trans-Atlantic Doctoral Conference; LBS Ghoshal Conference; SMS	
Additional	Citizenship: USA	
	Languages: English, Mandarin, Spanish (Intermediate)	
	Computing: STATA, Python, R, MATLAB, BigQuery, $\text{\LaTeX}$	
References	Michael G. Jacobides	Keyvan Vakili
	Sir Donald Gordon Professor of Entrepreneurship & Innovation	Associate Professor of Strategy & Entrepreneurship
	London Business School	London Business School
	mjacobides@london.edu	kvakili@london.edu
	Kristina McElheran	Francisco Brahm
	Associate Professor of Strategic Management	Assistant Professor of Strategy & Entrepreneurship
	University of Toronto	London Business School
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